

Update

VOLUME I

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NO. 2

GOD'S PRIORITY

The word "Christian" means "Christ-like." It means that Christians are to be like Christ. This means that His concerns, His goals, and His priorities are to also become theirs. Christ stated His chief concern, His number one goal, His top priority when He said, "For the Son of Man is come to seek and save that which was lost." It was the salvation of souls which brought our Lord from the streets of gold to the dusty streets of old Jerusalem.

That the salvation of souls is the priority of the Father is evident in John 3:16. He gave His Son as a sacrifice to save men. That God the Father would literally sacrifice His only Son with whom He had existed in an intimate bosom relationship from time immemorial, in order to save fallen sinful man, certainly is testimony to the priority of God the Father in the redemption of the lost.

The interest of the Third Member of the Blessed Trinity in soul-winning is evident in His involvement in a lost soul's conversion. It is the Holy Spirit who enlightens, convicts, and regenerates the unbeliever, baptizing him into the body of Christ making all the truly saved brothers in the Lord and members of Christ's body.

One of the best passages in the Scripture indicating heaven's interest in the salvation of men is Luke, chapter 15. The lost sheep, the lost coin, and the prodigal son all illustrate heaven's priority. It is the **one** lost sheep that the shepherd leaves the ninety and nine and goes into the wilderness seeking. The woman lit the candle and swept the house in diligent search for the lost coin. The prodigal's Father spotted His wayward son a good distance from the house indicating a constant vigilance for His lost son.

All these are parables given to illustrate God's concern over **one** lost soul. His concern should be ours also. Notice the **joy** in heaven (vv. 7 & 10) over **one** sinner that repented. That joy would include God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit and probably the angels also. By the way, this also explains why the joy is gone out of many church services and many Christian's lives. They are not seeing sinners repent and therefore have little or nothing to rejoice over.

However, probably the clearest passage on Christ's priority of reaching the lost is His parting words to His church. The great commission was probably given to the five hundred on the mountaintop in Galilee. It included a

good portion or representation of the entire church at that time and the Apostles. His parting plea (literally a command) was for His church to "teach all nations." The word "teach" literally means "make disciples." Therefore, if the church is to take Christ's command seriously, her first and foremost responsibility to Christ her head and to society is to win the lost and then teach them, which of course would include teaching **them** to win the lost.

The church which has ceased to win the lost has forfeited her purpose for existing. The people who are not winning the lost (and you cannot "teach them all things" until you win them) are in rebellion to their Lord. Every ministry of any Christian organization ought to have as the bottom line the salvation of souls. No organization or institution has a right to exist as "Christian" which does not have as its final and ultimate goal the salvation of souls.

So — let's pray for each other that God's priority will be **our** priority. Let's rededicate ourselves to soul-winning. Let's gear everything about our lives and services to the winning of the lost at any cost. Let's ask God to take a little heavenly windex and cleanse our spiritual eyes that we may see and value a soul as He does, that His number one priority will also become ours!

— A.B. Brown



Southeastern Association of Church Schools awarded three scholarships to teacher education students enrolled at Southeastern Free Will Baptist College. Those receiving the scholarships were (L to R) Kim French, Gateway FWB Church; Keith Grubbs, Ruth's Chapel; and Angela Griffin, Trinity, Greenville, NC.

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"ON THE GO WITH BRO. JOE"

"In Thee, O Lord, do I put my trust" (Psalm 71:1). Since the last issue of Update, it has been my joy to be with many of you in your homes and churches. We were privileged to be in revivals in Florence, SC, Cramerton, Grifton, and La-Grange, NC. God's blessings were evident in each of these revivals and many decisions were recorded for eternity. To God be the Glory!

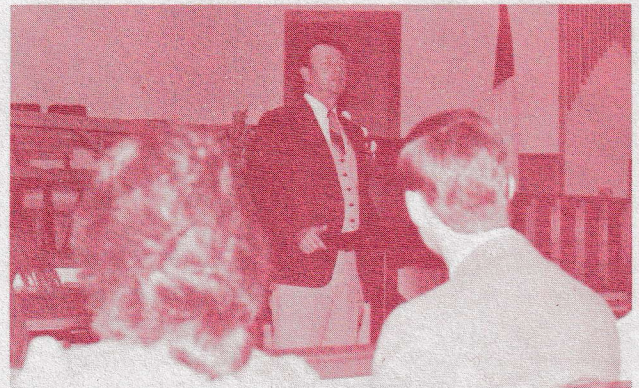
Our students are being used to win souls in our services. Recently, in Grifton, the drama team and basketball teams joined me for services. We went soul winning on Saturday all day and souls were saved. In the service that night, a man and woman who had been saved came forward and made their salvation public. SOUL WINNING IS THE BOTTOM LINE AT SOUTHEASTERN FREE WILL BAPTIST COLLEGE.

We have visited churches in Tennessee, Kentucky, West Virginia, North Carolina, South Carolina and Alabama. Your reception has been a blessing to me and your faithful support to Southeastern FWB College is greatly appreciated. If you would desire for me or a Gospel Team to come to your church, please contact me at the college. We wish you all a very blessed holiday season and may the Christ of Christmas save many souls in your churches.

—Joe R. Haas, Promotional Director

WELCOME DAYS! MARCH 30 - APRIL 1

Prospective students will arrive Thursday night and will leave Sunday after church. They will attend classes Friday and will be honored at a special fellowship meeting Friday night. Saturday morning they will be visiting with bus captains, military leaders, teen and junior workers. They will round out the day Saturday with a giant youth rally under the direction of Bro. Nate Ange. After attending services at Gateway FWB Church Sunday morning, they will head home. This will give them an excellent view of the ministry of Southeastern FWB College and its relationship to Gateway FWB Church.



Speaker at Missions Conference - Pete Minor, RI

MISSIONARY CONFERENCE — Our first Missionary Conference, October 23-25th, was a time of great soul searching and blessings from the Lord. Our speakers, Lonnie Sparks, Pete Minor and Jim Walker were especially anointed by the Holy Spirit and spoke to our hearts as the Word of God was preached in power. Several of our students answered the call of God to become missionaries wherever the Lord would choose to call them. The conference was climaxed by a missionary drama presented by the students. The altars and aisles were filled with people dedicating themselves to God and His will for their lives.

Each week the faculty, staff and students are required to go on some type of soul winning visitation. Many of our students who had never won a soul to Christ prior to coming to Southeastern, have won their first soul this semester. During the month of November, students reported 51 salvation decisions and 12 rededications while the faculty and staff reported 15 salvation decisions and 9 rededications.

COMING EVENTS:

- January 3 Registration for second semester. Classes begin January 4.
- March 1-3 Basketball Tournament
- April 1-4 Conference on Soul Winning & Evangelism